▼ GLASSHOUSE



MAHISHASUR GOES BLOND AND BEYOND

Durga Puja pandals in Bengal have had their share of jaw-droppers over the years, but this orange-maned foe could be the talking point this year. In Murshidabad's Khagra Shamshan Ghat, amid the feasting and frantic pandal-hopping, visitors have been stumped by an unlikely tableau: Goddess Durga taking aim, not at Mahishasura, but a Trump doppelgänger. The Puja committee claims inspiration from the "great betrayal"—tariffs, visas, trade tantrums—and artist Asim Pal dutifully birthed 'Trumpasura'. The satire and gore don't stop there. A quick stroll to Sadhak Narendra Smriti Sangha unveils Durga unleashing unimaginable vengeance on the heads of our neighbouring countries—Pakistan's Shehbaz Sharif and Bangladesh's Muhammad Yunus. The theme 'Dahan (immolation)', organisers say gravely, is about "burning the enemies of the nation". It seems this year's pandals are all about slaying our 'international demons'.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ BLURRED LINES

SMUT REBUT

Last month, Barmer and Jaisalmer woke up to a bizarre sight: hoardings across kilometres splashed with a blurred screenshot of a man engaged in a sexual act. The target: ex-MLA Mewa Ram Jain, 73, back in the Congress fold after being expelled in 2023. Scandal has long shadowed Jain—threats over a sex CD in 2012, a viral clip that led to his expulsion, a POCSO case (since acquitted)



and an ED raid over alleged crores paid as hush money. What raised eyebrows was Rajasthan Congress chief Govind Singh Dotasra, who had expelled Jain, presiding over his return (reportedly at ex-CM Ashok Gehlot's insistence). Unsurprisingly, local party leaders in Barmer are up in arms, perhaps the reason for the smutty posters now dotting the desert highways.